

StepCat

Payout Calculator - Quick Start Guide

App v253.1 and Profitability Workbook v253.1

August 22, 2026 workbook and reporting update

Release note: v253.1 is the current recommended workbook. An August 11 corrected v253.0 workbook may continue to perform the core calculations if it is calculating normally. Update to v253.1 for the latest reporting, mobile row-insertion guidance, shorter special-record labels, and alignment refinements.

All screenshots in this guide reflect the current v253.1 interface or the current public blank v253.1 workbook.

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Fastest workflow: Choose Entry Mode (Step 1), confirm Membership Type (Step 2), complete Game Entry (Step 3), open Review Entry (Step 4), then choose Calculate & Save.

Record-copy rule: When moving existing records, copy only A5:M through the last actual record row. Do not copy unused yellow rows down to the red boundary, and never copy N:Z.

1. Four-step entry workflow

Choose Estimate for a projection or Finalized for a completed result. Membership Type is Step 2 and becomes available after Step 1 is confirmed. Gold indicates the current action; completed steps move to the completed state.

The screen is titled "Entry Mode" in gold. At the top, there are three buttons: "D" (small), "STEP 1" (highlighted in gold), and "Required" (small). Below this, a message reads: "Choose Estimate for a projection or Finalized for a completed result. This is the first required choice." A light blue box contains the text: "Switching modes keeps the current unfinished entry. Use Start New Entry when recording a different challenge." At the bottom, there are two large buttons: "Estimate" (with "Projection" below it) and "Finalized" (with "Completed result" below it). A final instruction at the very bottom says: "Tap Estimate or Finalized to confirm this entry."

Entry Mode - Step 1, before a selection.

The screen is titled "Membership Type" in gold, with a trophy icon above the title. At the top, there are three buttons: "E" (small), "STEP 2" (highlighted in gold), and "Required" (small). Below this, a message reads: "Estimate selected. Confirm Member or Non-Member (Step 2) to continue." There are two large buttons: "Non-Member" (with a person icon) and "Member" (with a star icon). Below these buttons, a message says: "Selection required - tap Member or Non-Member for this entry." At the bottom is a button labeled "Show Math".

Membership Type - Step 2 after Estimate is selected.

Current Settings labels: Remember Estimate / Finalized Mode, Remember Game Entry Layout, Remember Membership Choice, and Remember Payment / Record Type.

2. Game Details and Calculation Information

Step 3 uses focused subsections in Guided Sections mode. Show All Fields can be used when you prefer the complete Step 3 form together. The example below is an Estimate for Step Marathon.

Game Details
Identification, dates, notes, and copied-date format

In progress

Game Name
A Optional
Step Marathon

Game Start Date
B Optional
08/13/2026
Selected start date: 08-13-2026

Game End Date
C Optional
09/06/2026
Selected end date: 09-06-2026

Payment / Record Type
F Optional
Points

Notes
M Optional
Optional notes, e.g. Original entry: \$13.85 cash and 26.15 points

Copied Date Format
Web
MM-DD-YYYY

Continue to Calculation Information

Game Details: Step Marathon, 08/13/2026 to 09/06/2026, Points.

Calculation Information
Pot, entry fee, and player counts

Complete

Required fields must be completed for the selected Entry Mode. Optional fields may remain blank.

Gross Pot
G Required
46440

Entry Fee
H Required
60

Eligible Players
I Required
656

Total Players
J Optional
774

Continue to Review

Calculation Information: Gross Pot 46,440; Entry Fee 60; Eligible 656; Total 774.

Estimate rule: An Estimate does not require Final Earned / Chips. Finalized entries require the completed result unless Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee is selected.

3. Review, Calculate & Save

When required Step 3 values are ready, choose Review Entry. Step 4 shows the complete record before anything is saved. Use Edit beside any review group to return to the exact section that needs a correction.

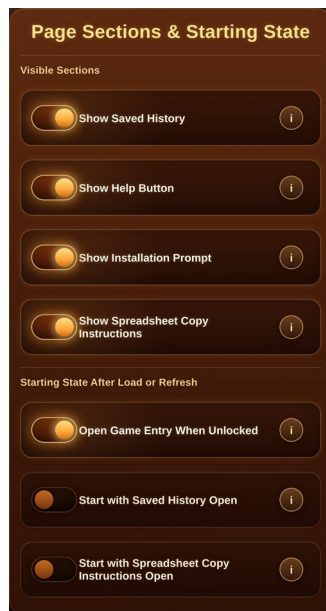
Step 4 Review Entry with Calculate & Save ready.

After a successful save: the completed fields remain visible for review during the current session, while that completed record is removed from unfinished-draft recovery. Use Start New Entry when you are ready to reset the form.

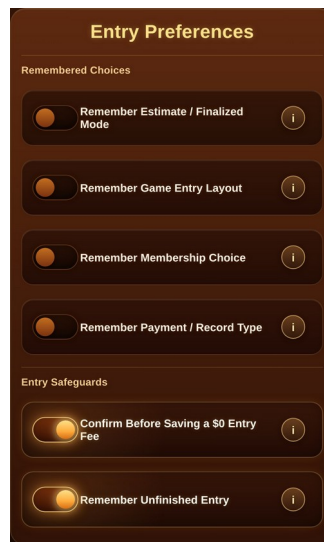
Device storage: Saved History, Settings, and unfinished StepCat fields remain in the current browser/device. Completed records become cross-device records only after they are entered in the Google Sheet.

4. Settings

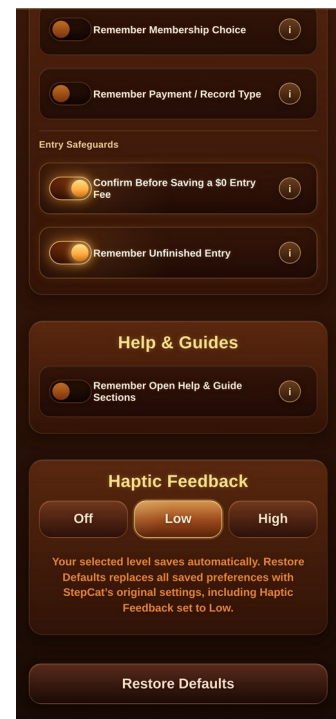
Ordinary setting changes save automatically. Restore Defaults is the bulk reset action. These are the current v253.1 Settings groups and labels.



Page Sections & Starting State.



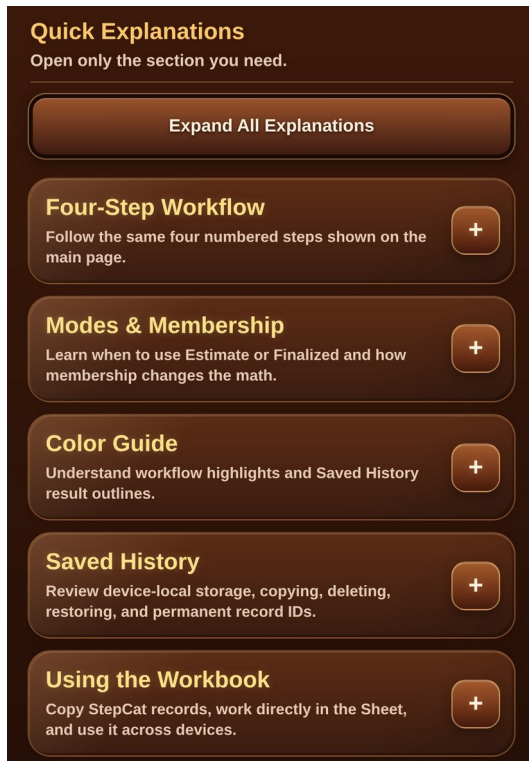
Entry Preferences and Entry Safeguards.



Help & Guides, Haptic Feedback, and Restore Defaults.

5. Help & Resources

Quick Explanations use the current topic name Using the Workbook. Guides & Workbook contains the current HTML guides, Google Sheets copy link, migration dialog, PDF, and editable DOCX.



Quick Explanations overview.



Guides & Workbook and downloadable resources.

6. Using the workbook

The Google Sheet is the permanent cross-device record. Enter or paste A:M only. Leave N:Z untouched so protected formulas calculate results and reports automatically.

Using the Workbook

Copy StepCat records, work directly in the Sheet, and use it across devices.

Copying StepCat Records

Complete Step 4, save the record, then use Copy This Sheet Row. Paste it into the first empty column-A cell in Game Records.

Using the Workbook Without StepCat

The calculator is optional. Enter or paste values in A–M; leave N–Z untouched so the workbook can calculate its results and reports.

Spreadsheet Apps & Devices

Google Sheets provides the complete StepCat formulas, reports, automatic saving, and access from devices signed into the same Google account. Other spreadsheet apps can hold copied rows for basic recordkeeping, but may not reproduce the StepCat formulas or reports.

Adding Records on Mobile

To add a record between existing records, insert a whole worksheet row above the desired position and enter or paste A–M. The red ACTIVE RECORD BOUNDARY moves down temporarily. When finished, delete the same number of unused blank rows immediately above the red boundary to return it to row 505. Never delete the red boundary itself.

Direct workbook use, devices, and mobile row insertion.

Moving Older Records

The August 22 v253.1 workbook is recommended, but an August 11 corrected v253.0 workbook can continue to perform the core calculations. If your copy predates the August 11 corrections, shows formula/reference errors, or you want the v253.1 reporting and mobile-workflow improvements, create the current v253.1 copy and transfer A5:M only through the last actual record row into A5 (for example, A5:M198 if row 198 is the last record). Unused yellow rows down to the red boundary do not need to be copied. No Carryover is needed merely to update.

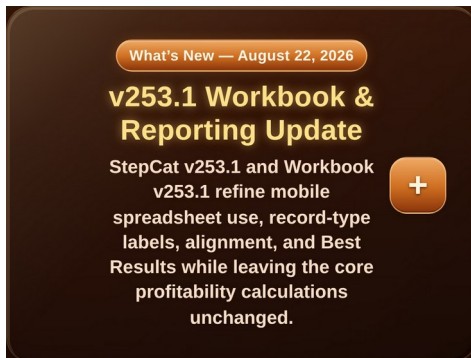
- **Computer:** use **Paste special** → **Values only**.
- **Phone or tablet:** select the destination column-A cell, press and hold, and choose Paste.
- **Do not copy:** N–Z, headers, entire rows, entire sheets, reports, or charts.
- **500-record limit:** rows 5–504 are the normal active record area. If inserted rows move the boundary down, remove equivalent unused blank rows immediately above it. When all 500 record positions are actually filled, start a fresh workbook and use Carryover.

Moving older records, A5:M transfer, and the 500-record boundary.

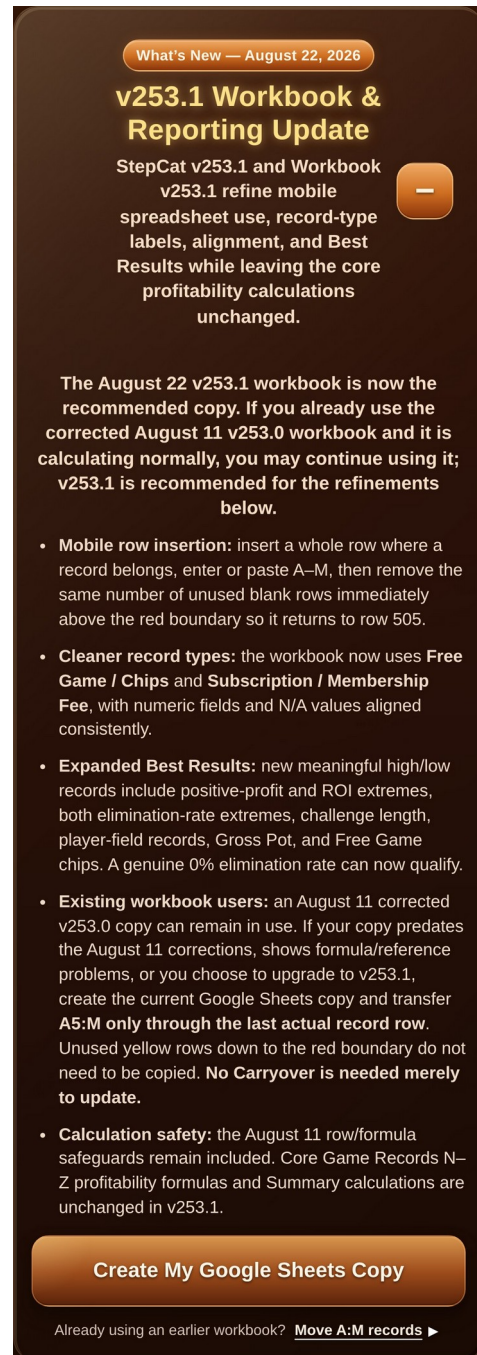
Mobile insertion: Insert a whole worksheet row above the desired position, enter or paste A:M, then remove the same number of unused blank rows immediately above the red boundary so it returns to row 505. Never delete the red boundary itself.

7. Workbook update and migration

v253.1 is recommended, but an August 11 corrected v253.0 workbook may remain in use if it is calculating normally. Updating is strongly recommended for older copies that predate those corrections or show formula/reference problems.



What's New - v253.1 overview.

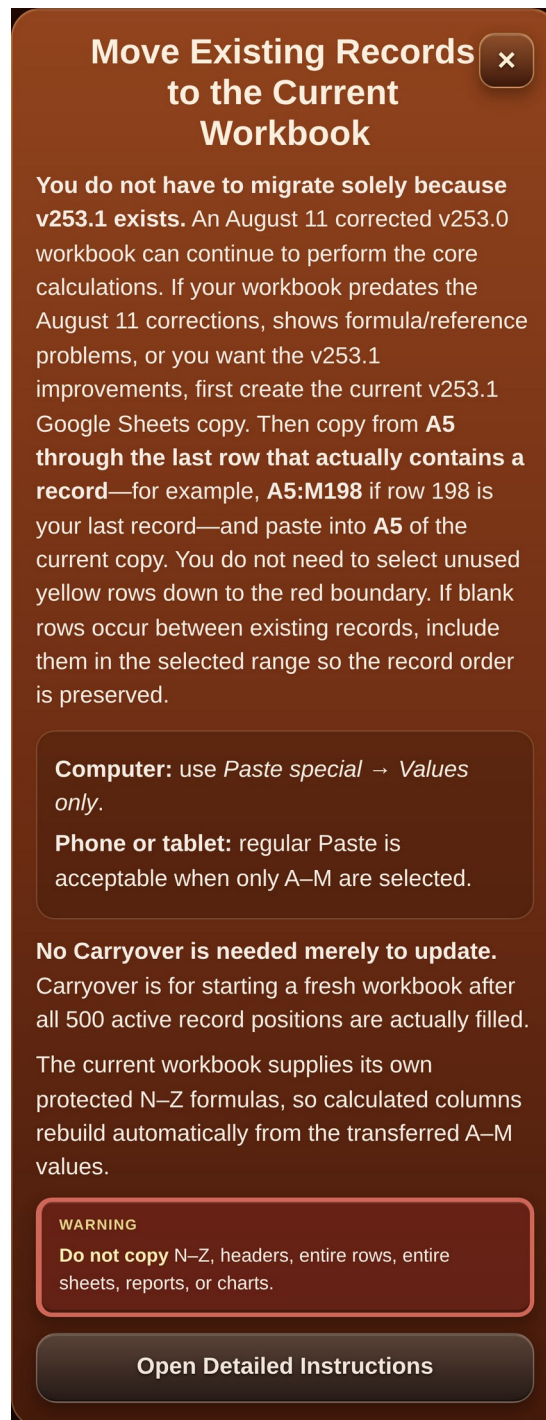


Expanded v253.1 Workbook & Reporting Update.

- Copy A5:M through the last actual record row (for example A5:M198 if row 198 is the last record).
- Do not select unused yellow rows down to the red boundary. Include blank rows that occur between existing records.
- Computer: Paste special -> Values only. Mobile: regular Paste is acceptable when only A:M are selected.
- Do not copy N:Z, headers, entire rows, entire sheets, reports, charts, or the red boundary.
- No Carryover is needed merely to update. Carryover is for a fresh workbook after all 500 active record positions are actually filled.

8. Move Existing Records dialog

The corrected mobile dialog opens at its true top, scrolls to its true bottom, keeps an accessible close control, and browser/Android Back closes the dialog before leaving StepCat.



Move Existing Records with current A5:M transfer guidance and reachable controls.

9. Google Sheets workbook - Instructions

The public blank v253.1 workbook is used for workbook screenshots so no personal records appear in the documentation.

StepCat Workbook Instructions — v253.1	
Google Sheets working version with insertion-safe expanding formulas and migration guidance.	
Start here	Create one Google Sheets copy for everyday use. Enter or paste records in Game Records A:M beginning at row 5. N:Z calculate automatically and must not be edited.
Cross-device use	The Google Sheet is the permanent cross-device record and can be maintained directly without StepCat. Open the same Sheet on any device signed into the same Google account, enter or paste A:M, and leave N:Z untouched so the workbook calculates automatically. StepCat's unfinished fields, settings, and Saved History remain in the current browser/device and do not transfer automatically.
Editable columns	Use A:M for record information. N:Z are generated by protected expanding formulas anchored above the record area. Inserting a whole row above or below an existing record does not require copying formulas.
Correcting an existing record	Edit only the incorrect A:M input cells on the existing Game Records row. N:Z recalculate automatically. Do not replace, clear, or edit the calculated cells.
Desktop transfer or relocation	On a computer, copy only populated A:M values. Insert a whole destination row, select its column-A cell, and use Paste special -> Values only. Confirm N:Z, Record Review, and totals before deleting the original row.
Mobile transfer or relocation	On mobile, the easiest way to add a record between existing records is to insert a whole worksheet row above the desired position, then enter or paste A:M. The red ACTIVE RECORD BOUNDARY moves down temporarily. Afterward, delete the same number of unused blank rows immediately above the red boundary to return it to row 505. Never copy an entire row because it includes N:Z.
Profit rule	Enter the total payout returned by the platform in Final Payout / Chips, not profit alone. Example: a \$40 entry with \$3.36 profit is entered as \$43.36. Profit means Result Earned is above Entry Fee.
Draw rule	A normal completed paid game earning the Entry Fee or less is treated as a Draw with \$0.00 net profit. The exact raw estimate remains visible in Estimated Earned.
Loss rule	A monetary loss occurs only when Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee is Yes on a paid entry; the full Entry Fee is counted as lost.
Subscriptions	For the annual platform membership, select "Subscription / Membership Fee," enter the annual cost in Entry Fee, and set Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee to No. Gross Pot, Eligible Players, Total Players, and Final Payout may be entered as N/A because this is a non-game expense. Subscription rows do not change Running Net Game Profit; Summary subtracts membership/subscription costs separately when calculating Actual Running Net Profit.
Free games	Select "Free Game / Chips" for a completed free-entry challenge or a record that awards chips/game credit. Enter chips in Final Payout / Chips when known. Choose No in Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee for a completed free game and Yes only if it was disqualified. Game Type may be N/A only when historical membership status is unavailable.
Summary	Summary uses exact counts and cash totals. Free Games are shown separately from paid-game Profit, Draw, and Disqualified counts, and their chips are reported in a separate non-cash total.
Game Comparisons	The paid table compares Member, Non-Member, Unclassified, and All Paid Games. A separate Free Game Chip Performance section shows completed, disqualified, chips-earned, eliminated-player, and elimination-rate statistics. Subscription rows are excluded.
Gross Profit Earned	The sum of positive paid-game cash profit before subtracting lost entry fees or membership fees. Free Game chips are excluded.
Net Game Profit	Gross paid-game cash profit minus total lost entry fees. Free Game chips are excluded from cash net profit.
Actual Running Net Profit	Running Net Game Profit minus current and carryover annual subscription or membership costs. Free Game chips remain separate.
Column Z colors	Column Z shows cumulative net game profit. Its color describes the current row's result or record type, not whether the cumulative total is positive or negative. Draw and Subscription rows may repeat the preceding total.
Light green	Profit
Light gray	Draw
Pale yellow / cream	Free Game / chips
Light blue	Subscription
Light red	Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee
Mobile copy and paste	On mobile, ordinary Paste is acceptable only when the copied selection contains A:M values and no calculated columns. A StepCat Copy Sheet Row paste is preferred because it contains record values only. Confirm that the destination row's N:Z results appear automatically.
Starting Midyear	Choose one continuation method: transfer prior A:M records to preserve full detail, or use Carryover Setup for totals only when you are not transferring those rows. When transferring records, copy only from row 5 through your last actual record row—for example, A5:M198 if row 198 is your last record. You do not need to copy unused yellow rows down to the red boundary. Include any blank rows that occur between existing records, but never copy N:Z or the red boundary row.
Workbook capacity	The Google Sheets version supports a maximum of 500 active records, normally entered in rows 5–504. The ACTIVE RECORD BOUNDARY is intended to remain at row 505. If whole rows are inserted above it, the boundary moves temporarily; remove the same number of unused blank rows immediately above it to return the boundary to row 505. When all 500 active record positions are actually filled, start a fresh workbook and use the Carryover alternative.
Editing, inserting, and deleting	A:M are editable; N:Z are calculated. To add a record between existing records, insert a whole worksheet row above the desired position and enter or paste A:M. The red boundary may move down temporarily. After inserting rows, delete the same number of unused blank rows immediately above the red boundary to restore it to row 505. Never delete the red boundary itself, and do not use Delete cells and shift left or up.

Upper Instructions sheet - v253.1 record rules and workflow guidance.

9A. Carryover alternative

Carryover alternative	Use only when starting a fresh record list without transferring prior Game Records rows. Enter prior totals once, then continue with new records.
Prior Net Game Profit	\$0.00
Prior Subscription Costs	\$0.00
Prior Game Count	0
Step 1 — Note prior totals	If you are not transferring the prior A:M records, open the completed or archived workbook and note its ending Net Game Profit, subscription costs already paid, and completed-game count.
Step 2 — Enter once	Enter those three figures once in B31:B33. Do not also copy the prior Game Records rows; using both methods would count the same activity twice.
Step 3 — Continue records	Begin new records on Game Records row 5. Enter only activity that occurred after the previous workbook ended.
Step 4 — Check totals	Running totals and Summary should begin with the carryover figures and then add only the new workbook's records.
Important	Carryover is an alternative to transferring prior rows. If you copy populated A5:M records into this workbook, leave B31:B33 at 0. Prior Game Count includes completed games only; exclude Subscription rows and unfinished Estimate rows.

Lower Instructions sheet - Carryover alternative and its safeguards.

Carryover is an alternative, not an update step: If you transfer prior A:M records into the current workbook, leave Carryover values at zero. Use Carryover only when starting a fresh record list without transferring the prior rows.

10. Game Records A:M and N:Z

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	Running Net Game Profit: \$0.00 Gross Profit Earned: \$0.00 Total Lost												
2	Google Sheets working version v253.1. Enter or paste in A:M only. N:Z are generated by protected expanding fo												
3	A:M — Inputs only												
4	Game Name	Start Date	End Date	Entry Mode	Game Type	Payment / Record Type	Gross Pot / Chips	Entry Fee	Eligible Players	Total Players	Final Payout / Chips	Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee	Notes
5				▼	▼	▼						▼	
6				▼	▼	▼						▼	
7				▼	▼	▼						▼	
8				▼	▼	▼						▼	
9				▼	▼	▼						▼	
10				▼	▼	▼						▼	
11				▼	▼	▼						▼	
12				▼	▼	▼						▼	
13				▼	▼	▼						▼	
14				▼	▼	▼						▼	
15				▼	▼	▼						▼	
16				▼	▼	▼						▼	
17				▼	▼	▼						▼	
18				▼	▼	▼						▼	
19				▼	▼	▼						▼	
20				▼	▼	▼						▼	
21				▼	▼	▼						▼	

Game Records A:M - input columns only.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	Running Net Game Profit: \$0.00 Gross Profit Earned: \$0.00 Total												
2	Google Sheets working version v253.1. Enter or paste in A:M only. N:Z are generated by protected expanding												
3	A:M — Inputs only												
4	Game Name	Start Date	End Date	Entry Mode	Game Type	Payment / Record Type	Gross Pot / Chips	Entry Fee	Eligible Players	Total Players	Final Payout / Chips	Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee	Notes
48				▼	▼	▼						▼	
49				▼	▼	▼						▼	
50				▼	▼	▼						▼	
51				▼	▼	▼						▼	
52				▼	▼	▼						▼	
53				▼	▼	▼						▼	
54				▼	▼	▼						▼	
55				▼	▼	▼						▼	
56				▼	▼	▼						▼	
57				▼	▼	▼						▼	
58				▼	▼	▼						▼	
59				▼	▼	▼						▼	
60				▼	▼	▼						▼	
61				▼	▼	▼						▼	
62				▼	▼	▼						▼	
63				▼	▼	▼						▼	
64				▼	▼	▼						▼	

Game Records A:M farther down the sheet with rows 1-4 frozen.

	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
1	s Profit Earned: \$0.00 Total Lost Entry Fees: \$0.00 StepCat v253.1													
2	generated by protected expanding formulas anchored above the record area; do not edit or paste into N:Z.													
3	N:Z — Protected formulas													
4	Notes	Adjusted Pot / Chips	Estimated Earned / Chips	Result Earned / Chips	Profit	Draw	Lost	ROI	Result	Challenge Length (Weeks)	Net Profit	Eliminated Players	Elimination Rate	Running Net Profit
5														
6														
7														
8														
9														
10														
11														
12														
13														
14														
15														
16														
17														
18														
19														
20														
21														
22														

N:Z protected formula columns. Do not edit or paste into these columns.

11. Summary and Best Results

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	StepCat Live Summary Dashboard — v253.1					
2						
3	Game Result	Game Count	Share of Paid Games	Cash / Credit Total	Amount	What It Represents
4	Profit Games	0	0.0%	Running Net Game Profit	\$0.00	Gross profit minus lost entry fees
5	Draw Games	0	0.0%	Gross Profit Earned	\$0.00	Positive paid-game cash profit only, before lost fees or membership costs
6	Disqualified Games	0	0.0%	Total Lost Entry Fees	\$0.00	Full entry fees lost from disqualification
7	Current Workbook Paid Games	0	0.0%	Membership Fees	\$0.00	Annual membership cost, tracked as a separate non-game expense
8	Prior Completed Games (reference)	0		Actual Running Net Profit	\$0.00	Running cash net game profit minus current and carried-over membership costs
9	Completed Free Games (separate credit)	0	Separate	Free Game Chips Earned	0.00 chips	Non-cash chips/game credit earned from Free Games; excluded from every cash profit total
10						

Summary dashboard with exact counts and financial totals.

27			
30			
31	Running Tally	Exact Count	Share
32	Profit	0	0.0%
33	Draw	0	0.0%
34	Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee	0	0.0%
35	Free Game (separate credit)	0	Separate
36	Total Paid Games	0	0.0%
37			

Running Tally with exact counts and shares.

	A	B	C	D
1	Best Results — Live Reference Table — v253.1			
2	<i>Shows notable highs, lows, and record extremes found in Game Records. Values update automatically when records are added or changed.</i>			
3	Metric	Game	Value	Meaning
4	Highest Net Profit			Largest positive cash profit from one paid game
5	Smallest Positive Net Profit			Smallest cash profit above \$0 among profitable games
6	Highest ROI			Highest return on Entry Fee among profitable paid games
7	Lowest Positive ROI			Lowest positive return among profitable paid games
8	Largest Lost Entry Fee			Largest full Entry Fee lost to disqualification
9	Lowest Elimination Rate			Lowest recorded elimination percentage among finalized games, including a true 0%
10	Highest Elimination Rate			Highest recorded elimination percentage among finalized games
11	Longest Challenge			Most weeks in a finalized challenge
12	Shortest Challenge			Fewest weeks in a finalized challenge
13	Largest Player Field			Highest Total Players value among finalized games
14	Most Players Eliminated			Most players eliminated from one finalized game
15	Largest Paid-Game Gross Pot			Largest Gross Pot among paid game results
16	Highest Free-Game Chips Earned			Most chips/game credit earned from one completed Free Game

Best Results - Live Reference Table - v253.1 with all current metrics.

12. Installation, feedback, and troubleshooting

Installation

Use the hosted StepCat page in a supported browser. When installation is unavailable, use the Installation information and Add to Home Screen guidance. A local test page may not offer the same installation controls as the hosted site.

Feedback

Write Feedback prepares a message for your email app. Review the recipient, subject, and message before sending.

Troubleshooting

Calculate does not continue: Correct the highlighted field. StepCat identifies the first blocking value.

Free Game fee is rejected: Use Entry Fee 0 for Free Game / Chips, or choose another Payment / Record Type.

Membership or Entry Mode resets: Enable the matching Remember setting or make a fresh selection.

Saved entry appears as unfinished work: Current v253.1 removes a completed saved record from unfinished-draft recovery while leaving the completed fields visible for review during the current session.

Copied row does not calculate: Paste into the destination column-A cell and only across A:M. N:Z should calculate automatically.

Switching devices: Open the same Google Sheet on the other device. StepCat Saved History, settings, and unfinished fields do not automatically transfer.

Move Existing Records behavior: The current dialog keeps Close reachable, supports full scrolling, and browser/Android Back closes the dialog before navigating away.

Release check: After deployment, close old StepCat tabs/apps, reopen the hosted site, confirm v253.1 is displayed, open the public v253.1 workbook link, and verify that the current screenshots and downloadable guides load.